

BODY DOUBLING, DONE RIGHT

Work next to someone. Actually get things done.

Body doubling is the cheapest focus tool in this system: another human, same room or same call, separate tasks. No interaction required — **their presence does the work**. This guide shows you how to set sessions up, find partners, and use them without a gram of guilt.

01 · THE CORE IDEA

What is body doubling?

Body doubling is working alongside someone else — in person or virtually — while you each do your own tasks. You don't need to interact. You just need another human present.

It works because your brain registers another person working near you and thinks "we're doing work now." This taps into a social wiring that standard productivity advice ignores.

Why it works for ADHD brains: body doubling lowers the activation energy needed to start a task. You were going to do it anyway. Now someone's there. So you start.

02 · SETUP

Setting up a virtual body doubling session

What you need

- A video call link (Zoom, Google Meet, Discord, FaceTime)
- A clear statement of what you'll work on
- A timer (optional)
- One or more other people who also want to get something done

Step by step

1**Schedule a 60–90 minute block.**

Shorter is fine. Longer than 90 minutes and focus tends to drift.

2**State your task at the start of the call.**

Be specific. Not "I'll do admin" but "I'll clear my inbox and send three invoices."

3**Mute microphones.**

Keep cameras on if you want the visual cue that someone's there. Cameras off with occasional check-ins works too.

4**Work.**

Don't chat. That's the whole point.

5**Check in at the halfway mark.**

30 seconds each. "Still going. Two invoices done. Switching to inbox."

6**Say what you finished at the end.**

This matters. Your brain needs to register the completion.

03 · PEOPLE

Finding body doubling partners

- Ask another freelancer or solopreneur you know
- Join a coworking Discord server (many exist, free)
- Use Focusmate (focusmate.com) — three free sessions per week
- Post on Twitter/LinkedIn: "Anyone want to do a 60-min body doubling session Thursday at 10am EST?"
- Join or start a weekly standing session with 2–3 people. Same time, same link, every week.

04 · THE LONG GAME

Accountability partnerships

A body doubling session is one-off. An accountability partner is ongoing.

How to set one up

1

Find someone with similar goals.

Another solopreneur is ideal. They don't need to be in your industry.

2

Agree on a check-in format.

Pick one that fits your week:

- Daily: one Slack message with your top 3 tasks
- Weekly: 15-minute call reviewing what got done
- Start-of-session: quick message before a focus block

3

Set a start date and an end date.

"Let's try this for four weeks and see how it works." This removes the pressure of "forever."

4

Be honest.

If you didn't do the thing, say so. No shame. Just "didn't happen, here's why, retrying tomorrow." The value is in the check-in, not in being perfect.

What accountability is not

- ✗ **It's not coaching.** You're not paying them to fix your life.
- ✗ **It's not venting.** Keep it focused on tasks and progress.
- ✗ **It's not competitive.** You're not racing. You're supporting.

05 · PROVE IT TO YOURSELF

The "Did the Thing" log

Your brain is bad at remembering what you actually accomplished. It's very good at remembering what you didn't do.

Keep a running list. Every day, write down 1–3 things you finished. Small things count. "Answered three emails" counts. "Wrote one paragraph of the proposal" counts.

At the end of the week, read the list. You'll be surprised how much you actually did.

Date: _____

Things I finished today:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

One thing I'm proud of:

Print this page. Fill it out. Keep it somewhere visible.

06 · TROUBLESHOOTING

Common problems and fixes

"I can't focus even with someone there."

Try shorter sessions. 25 minutes. Ten is fine. Build the muscle.

"I feel awkward being on camera."

Camera off is fine. Voice check-ins only. The presence is what matters, not the visual.

"I can't find anyone to body double with."

Start with Focusmate (free tier). Once you're comfortable, invite someone you know. Most people say yes — they also have things they've been putting off.

"I keep forgetting to do my check-ins."

Set a recurring calendar event. Same time every day. Treat it like a client meeting you can't skip.

START NOW

Now go schedule your first session – even 25 minutes counts.

Then open your Dopakit dashboard and log it under "**Small wins.**" That's how this system works: small steps, stacked. You've got this.